

1st interview

Interviewer: (0:00) Hi, this is Monish and I am taking a survey on algorithmic amplification of misinformation. Do I have a consent for that?

Respondent: Yes

Interviewer: (0:08) Can I know your name and age, please?

Respondent: I am Akash. My age is 19

Interviewer: (0:13) Okay

Interviewer: (0:14) Before we start I want to mention that you may choose not to answer any question if you want to Okay, let's start

Interviewer: (0:21) So, can you tell me which social media platforms you use most often?

Respondent: I (0:27) Mostly use Instagram YouTube and whatsapp on daily basis.

Interviewer: (0:33) Okay, so you're active across multiple platforms and How frequently do you rely on social media for news and important information?

Respondent: (0:38) I check social media almost every day and I do rely on it for quick news updates.

Interviewer: Got it

Interviewer: (0:45) Have you ever seen information online that you realized was false? What was it about?

Respondent: (0:51) Yes, I once saw a video online that looked very real where a celebrity was saying something controversial (0:59) Later, I found out that video was actually AI generated and not real.

Interviewer: That's interesting, especially with AI content becoming more common nowadays

Interviewer: (1:08) What made you believe That information really initially

Respondent: (1:12) So it looked very realistic and then the video quality and the voice matched with the person (1:18) So, yeah, I didn't suspect was fake.

Interviewer: Okay, so the realism of the content played a big role.

Respondent: Oh, yeah

Interviewer: (1:25) So, how did you eventually find out it was incorrect later?

Respondent: (1:29) I saw people in the comments mentioning it might be a fake and then (1:33) After checking online, I realized it was fake.

Interviewer: Okay

Interviewer: (1:38) Did that misinformation affect your opinion or any decision you made?

Respondent: (1:42) Yes for a short time it changed my opinion about that person until I found out

Interviewer: (1:48) Okay, so have you ever shared something that later turned out to be false? What happened?

Respondent: (1:55) I didn't share that particular video (1:57) But I did send it to a friend to ask if it was real and later we both realized it was fake

Interviewer: (2:02) That's understandable. Many people do that to confirm things

Interviewer: (2:06) So do you feel social media shows you certain type of content more often, why do you think that happens?

Respondent: (2:13) Yes (2:13) I noticed once I started seeing more similar controversial or viral videos after that probably because I watched it or interacted with it

Interviewer: Yeah

Interviewer: (2:23) Do you think posts with more likes shares or comments are more likely to appear in your feed?

Respondent: (2:28) Yeah, definitely. I think posts that get a lot of engagement are pushed more (2:31) Which is probably why I saw that video in the first place.

Interviewer: (2:34) Right ,What do you think is the biggest problem caused by misinformation online?

Respondent: I think the biggest problem is that it can be easily (2:43) Changed people's opinion based on something that isn't even real.

Interviewer: That's a very valid concern (2:48) Thank you for sharing your thoughts and before we end I want to mention that we are not using this audio for we're using this audio only for academic purposes (2:57) And we'll not be sharing it online.

Respondent: And thank you. Great. Thank you

2nd interview

Interviewer: (0:00) Hi, I'm Monish and I'm taking an interview on the topic algorithmic amplification of misinformation. Do I have your concern?

Respondent: Yeah, no problem

Interviewer: (0:08) Can I know your name and age, please?

Respondent: (0:11) My name is Navneet. I'm 19 years old

Interviewer: (0:15) Okay, so can you tell me which social media platforms you use most?

Respondent: (0:19) Mostly I use Insta, YouTube, Whatsapp and sometimes Twitter.

Interviewer: Okay, so you're quite active

Interviewer: (0:25) How frequently do you rely on social media for news or important information?

Respondent: (0:29) I check social media many times a day and sometimes I rely on it for quick updates.

Interviewer: Got it

Interviewer: (0:36) Have you ever seen information online that you later realized was false? What was it about?

Respondent: (0:41) Yes, many times. Once I saw a viral post claiming that Diet Coke was harmful and could (0:47) cause serious health issues and which was completely wrong and rubbish.

Interviewer: Oh, that sounds like something that could easily spread

Interviewer: (0:55) What would you believe or trust that information initially?

Respondent: (1:00) As told before I believed it initially because the post had images and detailed explanation and many people (1:06) In the comments were agreeing with it. So at first I thought it was completely genuine and correct

Interviewer: (1:13) Okay, so how did you eventually find out it was incorrect?

Respondent: (1:17) Later, I checked the reliable sources online and found out that the claim was exhausted and not socially proven

Interviewer: (1:24) Yeah, that makes sense.

Interviewer: Did that misinformation affect your opinion or any decision you made?

Respondent: (1:31) Yes (1:32) It did affect me. I avoided Diet Coke for some time until I understood that actually it was wrong.

Interviewer: Okay

Interviewer: (1:39) Have you ever shared something that later turned out to be false? What happened?

Respondent: (1:42) Yes, I mentioned it to some of my friends thinking it was true (1:47) But later I clarified and told the information was not accurate.

Interviewer: Good that you actually corrected it

Interviewer: (1:55) Do you feel social media shows you certain types of content more often? Why do you think that happens?

Respondent: (2:01) Yes, I noticed that the similar type of (2:04) Content keeps on repeating like the health or awareness related the post repeatedly after engaging it once

Interviewer: Okay

Interviewer: (2:12) So do you think posts with more likes shares or comments are more likely to appear in your feed?

Respondent: (2:17) Uh, yes, I think posts with more likes and shares are mostly likely to appear because they are considered more engaging, right?

Interviewer: (2:25) What do you think is the biggest problem caused by misinformation online?

Respondent: (2:31) The biggest problem is that it can spread unnecessary fear and (2:36) cause people making wrong decisions based on (2:39) Incomplete and false information.

Interviewer: Okay. Thank you (2:43) Before we end I want to mention that this will only be used for academic purposes and will not be posted online

Respondent: (2:48) Thank you. Okay, no problem

3rd interview

Interviewer: (0:00) Hi, I am Monish and I am taking a survey on the topic Algorithmic Amplification of Misinformation.

Interviewer: (0:06) Do you have your consent?

Respondent: (0:08) Yeah, okay.

Interviewer: (0:09) So, can I know your name and age please?

Respondent: (0:11) My name is Girish and my age is 19.

Interviewer: (0:15) Okay, before we start I want to mention, if you don't want to answer a question, you can obviously do that.

Respondent: (0:21) Okay.

Interviewer: (0:21) Okay, so let's start.

Interviewer: (0:23) Can you tell me which social media platforms you use most often?

Respondent: (0:26) I mainly use Instagram, YouTube and sometimes Twitter for updates and trending topics.

Interviewer: (0:31) Okay.

Interviewer: (0:32) So, how frequently do you rely on social media for news or important updates?

Respondent: (0:37) I check social media quite frequently, especially for trending news, but I usually verify important information elsewhere.

Interviewer: (0:43) That's good.

Interviewer: (0:44) Have you ever seen information online that you later realized was false?

Interviewer: (0:48) What was it about?

Respondent: (0:49) Yes, I once saw a viral post claiming that Google was giving away free laptops to students through a link.

Interviewer: (0:57) Okay, so what made you believe or trust that information initially?

Respondent: (1:02) I believed it at first because the post looked professional and many people were commenting and sharing it.

Interviewer: (1:10) Oh, so how did you eventually find out it was incorrect?

Respondent: (1:13) Later I searched about it online and found warnings that it was a scam and not an official order.

Interviewer: (1:20) Okay.

Interviewer: (1:21) Did that misinformation affect your opinion or any decision you made?

Respondent: (1:26) No, not really. It didn't affect any major decisions, but it did make me pause and double-check information more carefully afterward.

Interviewer: (1:33) That's a good takeaway.

Interviewer: (1:35) Have you ever shared something that later turned out to be false? What happened?

Respondent: (1:39) Yes, I shared it with a friend thinking it was useful, but I later told them not to trust it after realizing it was fake.

Interviewer: (1:47) Good that you actually corrected it.

Interviewer: (1:49) So, do you feel social media shows you certain types of content more often? Why do you think that happens?

Respondent: (1:55) Yes, I feel like I see more posts related to office tech and student content because I interact with those topics more.

Interviewer: (2:02) So, do you think posts with more likes, shares or comments are more likely to appear in your feed?

Respondent: (2:09) Yes, posts with more likes and shares definitely show up more often in my feed.

Interviewer: (2:14) Right.

Interviewer: What do you think is the biggest problem caused by misinformation online?

Respondent: (2:18) The biggest problem is that people can get scammed or misled very easily if they trust such information.

Interviewer: (2:24) That's a very important concern. Thanks for sharing that.

Interviewer: (2:28) Before we end, I want to mention that this information is only used for academic purposes and will not be shared online.

Interviewer: (2:36) Thank you Girish.

Respondent: (2:36) Thank you.